

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	742
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	11/2018
		Review Date:	04/2028

BEHAVIORAL EMERGENCY

- Most patients are non-violent, requiring only supportive care and transport.
- Responder and patient safety are paramount, especially when treating an aggressive or violent patient.
- If the patient is overly aggressive when EMS personnel arrive on scene, they shall withdraw to a safe location and request law enforcement.
- EMS personnel shall not approach or attempt to remove a violent patient from the scene without law enforcement present.
- Restraints are to be used only to prevent injury and assure the safety of the patient and responders.
- EMS personnel shall make every effort to preserve the patient's health, safety, and preserve their dignity, rights, and wellbeing.

ADULT

BLS

Scene Safety - Assess for immediate danger. Protect yourself and others. Summon law enforcement if needed.

Restraints - Apply for patient and EMS safety

- Assure restraints do not compromise respirations, circulation, and neurological function
- Reassess and document distal circulation, sensation, and movement status every 15 minutes

Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed.

Blood Sugar Check - For patients who have ALOC.

ALS

Follow BLS procedures if applicable.

Obtain 4-Lead ECG – If indicated.

Vascular Access – If indicated.

For Extreme Agitation

Midazolam – 2 mg IV/IO OR 5 mg IN/IM

- Titrate **1 mg** IV/IO increments as needed to a max dose 5 mg
- May repeat 5 mg IN/IM once after 10 minutes if necessary

Signatures on File

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EMS Administrator

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EMS Medical Director

Special Considerations

- Physical restraint should be considered first and used, if possible, prior to chemical restraint.
- Methods or other materials applied in a manner that could cause respiratory, vascular, or neurological compromise, including prone restraints shall not be used.
- Handcuffs are for police use only.
- Restraints (hand cuffs) applied by law enforcement require the officer's continued presence to ensure patient and prehospital personnel safety. The officer should accompany the patient in the ambulance or follow the ambulance to the hospital.
- Do not apply, remove, or adjust handcuffs without direct instruction and supervision by law enforcement.
- A single EMS Personnel should be responsible for assessing, treating, and communicating with the patient.
- Multiple personnel attempting to intervene may increase patient's confusion and agitation.
 - Speak in a calm, quiet voice.
 - Approach the patient in a direct, honest manner.
 - The same EMS Personnel who rendered care at the scene should remain with patient during transport if patient condition allows.